

Decent Coaching Classes

VIII CBSE

Academic Conquest - I

Answer Key – Little Girls Wiser Than Men

SECTION A – READING

(i) Complete the sentences

- (a) scolded her, calling her a naughty, dirty girl.
- (b) forgetting their quarrel and playing together, damming the stream and floating a wood-chip in it.

(ii) Answer in own words (any 3)

- (a) Akoulya's mother struck Malasha; Malasha's mother came out and quarrelled with her, and the men joined in too, nearly coming to blows.
- (b) They dammed up the stream running across the road, making a channel with a wood-chip and floating it like a little boat.
- (c) She stepped in among the quarrelling men and pointed to the girls playing happily together, asking the men if they were not ashamed to fight over something the children had already forgotten.
- (d) It teaches that adults often hold on to anger and pride over trivial matters, while children forgive and forget easily — we should be as innocent, forgiving, and wise as little children.

(iii) Word meaning 'held firmly / grabbed'

seized

SECTION B – LITERATURE

(i) Brief answers (any 4)

- (a) Akoulya (the elder girl) told Malasha not to go into the puddle with her shoes on, because her mother would scold her.
- (b) Akoulya became angry because Malasha suddenly plumped her foot into the water, splashing muddy water on Akoulya's frock, eyes and nose.
- (c) Akoulya told her mother that Malasha had done it on purpose.
- (d) She seized Malasha and struck her on the back of her neck, making Malasha howl loudly.
- (e) The little one (Malasha) wore a blue frock and the elder (Akoulya) wore a yellow print frock; both had red kerchiefs on their heads.

(ii) Detailed answer

The girls, despite quarrelling briefly over the splashed frock, forgot their anger within minutes and went back to playing happily together. The adults, however, let the same trivial incident turn into a full-blown quarrel involving mothers, and nearly a fight among the men. It was only when the grandmother pointed to the innocent, forgiving children that the men felt ashamed of themselves. This contrast

shows that the children behaved with more wisdom, forgiveness and simplicity than the grown-ups, justifying the title of the story.

SECTION C – VOCABULARY

(i) Match the words

- (a) sledging — (iv) travelling over snow on a sledge
- (b) scrape — (iii) to remove something from a surface by moving a sharp edge across it firmly
- (c) lassies — (ii) young girls
- (d) ashamed — (i) feeling guilty or embarrassed

(ii) Sentences

To be assessed on correct and meaningful usage of any two of the given words.

SECTION D – GRAMMAR & WRITING

(i) Indirect speech

Akoullya told Malasha not to go in like that, adding that her mother would scold her.

(ii) Imaginative writing

To be assessed on coherent, relevant continuation of the story in the student's own words (e.g. the mothers, seeing the girls playing happily, also felt ashamed and made peace with each other).